SHRM Hackathon Submissions Overview

This document compiles all hackathon app submissions. Each prototype is presented on its own page with a clear, executive-ready summary.

Imagine spending millions on employee training but still not having the right sk

Submitted by: Nivrita Sharma **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Imagine spending millions on employee training but still not having the right skills in your workforce. That's the reality for most organizations today.
Companies lack visibility into actual skill gaps.
Training programs are generic, not role-specific, and not aligned with market standards.
As a result, budgets are wasted, and productivity suffers.
That's where UpskillX comes in.
Our AI-powered platform:

- Evaluates the top 10 skills per employee
- Compares them with market standards
- Identifies exact skill gaps
- Recommends personalized training
- And automatically generates a complete L&D budget plan

With UpskillX:

- Training becomes targeted
- Budget becomes optimized
- And workforce becomes future-ready.

We are not just identifying skill gaps; we are turning learning into a strategic advantage.

I am developing a JohnnyGPT for helping staff understand how to evaluate communi

Submitted by: Alex Alonso **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

I am developing a JohnnyGPT for helping staff understand how to evaluate communications and business concepts. It is an AI-based assistant designed to live on everyone's Microsoft communications tools (e.g., Outlook and Slack). There is a second use case to review financial business reporting and provide future-state predictions about the world of work.

The HR Navigator prototype, designed in Lovable, empowers employees with a strea

Submitted by: Denise Fenrick **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

The HR Navigator prototype, designed in Lovable, empowers employees with a streamlined, self-service platform for HR support. The portal provides automated responses to common HR inquiries, enabling employees to quickly access information and resolve issues independently. For questions that require personalized attention, employees can submit a support ticket directly through the portal. Tickets are automatically routed to the appropriate HR representative, ensuring efficient and accurate handling. An integrated dashboard allows employees to track the status of their tickets, view follow-up actions, and engage with HR reps as needed. This solution enhances employee experience, improves HR operational efficiency, and delivers real-time visibility into HR support interactions.

SHRM Growth Compass is an AI-powered personal development companion built for em

Submitted by: Niloufar Gomez **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

SHRM Growth Compass is an AI-powered personal development companion built for employees and HR professionals who want to make growth intentional, not accidental.

The problem: Traditional performance tools focus on evaluation, not development. Employees lack a safe, judgment-free space to reflect, set meaningful goals, and track their growth over time.

What it does:

AI Coaching Chat — an empathetic copilot that remembers your journal entries and goals, offering personalized insights instead of generic advice
Reflective Journaling — capture thoughts with mood tracking, linked to your growth goals
Auto-Generated Goals & Milestones — describe a growth area in conversation and the AI creates a structured goal with weekly milestones
Progress Insights — visualize patterns in your reflections and goal progress
Who it's for: Individual contributors, managers, and HR teams who believe growth happens through self-awareness — not annual reviews.

Create a daily 10-15 minute AI-generated audio digest podcast summarizing the to

Submitted by: Veronica Magan **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Create a daily 10-15 minute AI-generated audio digest podcast summarizing the top HR news from SHRM's HR Daily newsletter. This would be similar to NPR's Up First Podcast and allow us to provide our daily insights to our audiences in a new format without a lot of production and perhaps allow us to sell more sponsorships or ads.

Pathnex is an AI-powered career development platform designed to solve one of th

Submitted by: Karan Singh **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Pathnex is an AI-powered career development platform designed to solve one of the most persistent challenges in HR - The lack of personalized, role-specific development.

Today, most assessments and training programs are generic and disconnected from real job responsibilities, making it difficult for professionals to understand their actual skill gaps and take meaningful action.

Pathnex addresses this by combining role intelligence, SHRM BASK-aligned competency mapping, and high-quality, scenario-based assessments to evaluate individuals in the context of their actual work. It then translates these insights into clear, actionable development plans and tracks progress through a live dashboard, enabling continuous improvement and reassessment.

The solution is designed for working professionals, people managers, and HR teams who want a structured, data-driven, and practical approach to capability building and career growth.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Submitted by: Nidhika Mishra **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

PROBLEM STATEMENT
Title: The Learning–Application Gap
Organizations invest heavily in leadership / managerial / HR programs and workshops.
The real challenge is not learning - it is consistent application.
Learning remains conceptual and episodic
Managers struggle to apply what was taught in real situations
No system exists to translate learning into role-specific action
Organizations lack visibility on whether learning is actually showing up in behavior

The A.V.E. Framework™ (Alumni Value Ecosystem) transforms employee exit from a t

Submitted by: Nisha Kurup | **Team:**

Problem & Solution

The A.V.E. Framework™ (Alumni Value Ecosystem) transforms employee exit from a transactional endpoint into a continuous value engine for the enterprise.

Today, organizations invest heavily in hiring and retention—but lose visibility and access to talent, networks, and influence the moment employees leave. This creates a blind spot where proven talent, trusted relationships, and potential business opportunities go untapped.

Our prototype addresses this by introducing a simple, AI-enabled system that captures alumni value at exit, tracks their growth using publicly available data, and activates them across three outcomes: talent (rehire and referrals), brand (advocacy and influence), and business (lead generation and partnerships).

Designed for HR, talent leaders, and business teams, A.V.E. converts a static alumni database into a dynamic, intelligence-led ecosystem—enabling faster hiring, stronger brand reach, and warmer revenue pipelines.

Organizations today are sitting on a lot of employee data, but it's fragmented,

Submitted by: Animesh Rola **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Organizations today are sitting on a lot of employee data, but it's fragmented, delayed, and rarely actionable. By the time problems like burnout or attrition show up, it's already too late.

SignalForge solves this by acting as an always-on workforce intelligence engine. It continuously collects signals through surveys, productivity patterns, communication insights, and micro nudges, without adding friction for employees.

It then converts this data into real-time insights—highlighting happiness, productivity, and attrition risk across teams. But more importantly, it goes beyond dashboards by giving clear, actionable plans to managers on what to do next.

And we close the loop, by automatically following up with managers and employees to track whether those actions are actually working.

In simple terms, SignalForge helps organizations move from reacting to problems to predicting and preventing them, improving both employee experience and business outcomes."

Our prototype is an AI-powered cross-cultural communication copilot designed to

Submitted by: Amit Sethi | **Team:**

Problem & Solution

Our prototype is an AI-powered cross-cultural communication copilot designed to help managers navigate complex workplace interactions across global teams. In today's distributed work environment, managers frequently struggle with miscommunication caused by cultural differences in directness, hierarchy, and feedback styles. These gaps often lead to misunderstandings, reduced trust, and delays in execution—especially in high-stakes situations like missed deadlines, performance conversations, or stakeholder escalations. Our solution addresses this by transforming a real-world scenario into culturally intelligent communication. The tool takes inputs such as the manager's country, the colleague's country, relationship context, tone, and scenario and instantly generates the following: A tailored one-on-one conversation script, A ready-to-send email draft, cultural insights, risk indicators, and interpretation cues What sets this apart is not just content generation, but decision support—helping managers understand how their message may be perceived and how to adapt their approach for better outcomes. This solution is designed for people managers, HR leaders, and global teams who regularly collaborate across geographies and need to communicate with clarity, confidence, and cultural awareness.

Organizations struggle to align talent with business needs, especially during gr

Submitted by: Daniel Hozik **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Organizations struggle to align talent with business needs, especially during growth, restructuring or resource constraints, and employees lack visibility into opportunities beyond their immediate teams. The Internal Opportunity Exchange is an AI powered internal marketplace that fills these gaps, allowing managers (or anyone with a need) to post projects, to engage in cross departmental work. The project could be as small as needing help setting up chairs for an event or as large as taking on important tasks while a department is understaffed. this tool allows anyone (with optional approval flows) to post their need by sharing the project details, funding source. In addition, it gives people across companies the ability to see the skills employees posses by allowing them to create basic profiles to highlight their background.

Corporate Visa Decision Engine (US Mobility)

Submitted by: Judit Markarian **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Corporate Visa Decision Engine (US Mobility)
The Corporate Visa Decision Engine is a strategic decision-support system that helps global mobility and HR teams identify optimal US visa pathways based on business intent, employee profile, and organizational constraints. The system prioritizes business outcomes over visa categorization, providing ranked immigration strategies with risk, timeline, and strategic tradeoffs. The app is designed for global mobility professionals, HR business partners, immigration counsel teams, talent strategy leaders and workforce planning teams.

Civility Compass is a practical, SHRM-aligned diagnostic tool that helps organiz

Submitted by: Kristi Meacham **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Civility Compass is a practical, SHRM-aligned diagnostic tool that helps organizations identify where workplace friction may be rooted in incivility, weak psychological safety, manager inaction, or broader culture breakdowns — and what to do next.

The need is real. SHRM's Civility Index shows that workplace incivility remains common, with recent workplace scores staying in Zone 3, the "Take Action" range. SHRM's research also shows that incivility carries a significant business cost through lost productivity, absenteeism, lower morale, and higher turnover risk. Managers are a major variable: in recent waves, many workers said their manager could have done more to prevent incivility and cared more about business objectives than how people are treated.

Civility Compass turns that research into action.

A user enters a workplace issue in plain language — for example, tension after layoffs, repeated interruptions in meetings, passive-aggressive communication, exclusion, or conflict around political conversations. The tool analyzes the situation through a SHRM civility lens and returns a structured diagnosis, such as civility breakdown, manager-enabled incivility, low psychological safety, communication breakdown, or change-related civility stress. It then identifies key signals, assesses qualitative risk, surfaces likely root-cause hypotheses, and generates practical next steps.

What makes this tool different is that it does not jump straight to blame or legal conclusions. It is designed to help HR, managers, and leaders frame problems more clearly and respond more constructively. It focuses on patterns, not accusations. It helps users separate symptoms from causes, distinguish isolated tension from broader culture issues, and identify when a problem may warrant direct HR or ER review.

The recommendations are grounded in SHRM's broader workplace culture framework: honest and unbiased management, civil behavior, meaningful work and opportunities, open communication, and empathy. They are also informed by SHRM's findings that civility and psychological safety lead to better difficult conversations, stronger trust, greater innovation, and longer expected employee tenure.

In short, Civility Compass helps organizations move from vague tension and reactive

problem-solving to clearer diagnosis, stronger manager response, and more actionable culture repair — one conversation at a time.

Too many workplace decisions start with assumptions instead of facts, which caus

Submitted by: Daniel Hozik **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Too many workplace decisions start with assumptions instead of facts, which causes inconsistent documentation, missing needed context, and managers struggling to understand what they should do. Document Document Document is an AI powered decision support tool designed for HR professionals and managers, guiding them through their situation and what they need to consider as documentation to build their case and take proper action. It prompts users to gather the right information, document consistently, and consider risks, helping HR and managers stay better aligned.

This tool is a one-stop shop for filing for unemployment. When an employee is te

Submitted by: Daniel Hozik **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

This tool is a one-stop shop for filing for unemployment. When an employee is terminated, the goal is to make the process as simple and clear as possible, including providing step-by-step guidance on how to file. State unemployment websites are often confusing and difficult to navigate, especially during a stressful time like job loss. This tool centralizes the information and breaks it into easy steps to reduce uncertainty and stress. Small support like this can make a huge difference in the offboarding experience.

Organizations typically manage employee equipment (laptops, monitors, badges, ph

Submitted by: Daniel Hozik **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Organizations typically manage employee equipment (laptops, monitors, badges, phones, etc.) through spreadsheets, IT ticketing tools, and email chains. When employees are onboarded or offboarded, this can result in:
Lost or unreturned equipment
Delays in onboarding (employees waiting for devices)
Security and compliance risks (especially with remote workers)
Poor employee offboarding experiences
Excess manual coordination between HR, IT, and managers
Knowing what is company equipment vs client equipment

This tool helps alleviate the burden on HR and IT teams by streamlining equipment tracking and returns. It creates a structured process based on a few simple inputs and provides a centralized dashboard for visibility.

Implementing a new HRIS is one of the most complex transitions organizations go

Submitted by: Daniel Hozik **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Implementing a new HRIS is one of the most complex transitions organizations go through. A major pain point is developing test scripts that accurately reflect real HR processes across multiple functions. Most HR teams rely on manual documentation, spreadsheets, or IT input, which can lead to misinterpretation and gaps between how HR expects the system to work and how it is actually tested.

This AI-driven tool helps HR teams generate structured, customized test scripts based on their specific processes and system configurations.

Some of our most asked questions of our advisors are "What qualifies as FMLA?" o

Submitted by: Ben Hood **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Some of our most asked questions of our advisors are "What qualifies as FMLA?" or "Does this qualify as FMLA?" I created a simple tool, for both HR pros and employees, that walks the user through a decision tree- based on state- to make that determination. This also provides information about what is a serious illness, etc.

This is an AI vent tool built for HR professionals because sometimes the ridicul

Submitted by: Daniel Hozik **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

This is an AI vent tool built for HR professionals because sometimes the ridiculous happens and you need to just vent and laugh while also trying to be serious and do your job. You type in a frustration or situation that you shouldn't openly discuss in the workplace, and it creates a witty response, provides a fitting influential quote, and funny GIF. Its not about anything other than a lighthearted pressure release for the normal HR professional.

HR professionals make high-risk decisions every day without real-time clarity on

Submitted by: David Deir **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

HR professionals make high-risk decisions every day without real-time clarity on legal exposure, outcomes, or next steps.

The HR Intelligence Engine is an AI-powered decision support platform that analyzes workplace scenarios, identifies applicable laws, predicts risk, and surfaces similar real-world cases.

It is not designed to replace the legal department, but to support HR teams in making faster, more informed decisions and knowing when to escalate.

What makes it different is that it goes beyond insight — it helps HR take action by generating ready-to-use communications (emails, investigation questions, documentation) and allows users to save and reference past cases.

It is designed for HR professionals, especially teams of one or those without immediate access to legal support, helping them move from uncertainty to confident, informed decisions in seconds.

LeadPulse is an AI-powered tracker that eliminates manual lead monitoring. While

Submitted by: Apurva Ojha | **Team:**

Problem & Solution

LeadPulse is an AI-powered tracker that eliminates manual lead monitoring. While leads are already shared daily, teams still rely on manual effort to track follow-ups—leading to delays and missed opportunities. LeadPulse works on existing data to automatically track movement across stages, flag leads with no action in 48 hours, and highlight where the funnel is breaking. It turns passive data into real-time action—helping teams follow up faster, reduce lead leakage, and improve conversions without changing their current workflow.

Inspired by Project Buffalo on Wednesday, April 15,2025, SHRM InsightBridge is

Submitted by: Niloufar Gomez **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Inspired by Project Buffalo on Wednesday, April 15,2025, SHRM InsightBridge is proposed as a new SHRM product that helps HR leaders translate people data into compelling business narratives leaders can act on. The core insight: HR professionals have abundant data but lack clear, executive-ready storytelling that connects metrics to strategic outcomes.Merge our people data and our SHRM expertise into one tool that turns HR metrics into an executive narrative — instantly.

The HR Doc Genius / HR Doc Creator offers an easy-to-use service to members that

Submitted by: Jessica Langlois **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

The HR Doc Genius / HR Doc Creator offers an easy-to-use service to members that Knowledge Advisors are unable to directly provide: policy, document, form, and communication creation. This is an interactive, HR document builder with a self-service function for policy and document review and creation. It can generate customizable employment-related letters, forms, general employee communications, and applies current state and federal laws where applicable. The builder includes a disclaimer that the documents are provided for general informational use and are not a substitute for professional legal advice.

As economic volatility increases alongside shifts in government policy, many org

Submitted by: Audrey Rodriguez **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

As economic volatility increases alongside shifts in government policy, many organizations remain structurally unprepared for downturn cycles, relying on reactive workforce decisions rather than proactive planning.

The recent pandemic exposed significant risks in how companies manage talent, cost structures, and organizational stability during periods of uncertainty.

Now is a critical time to equip HR leaders with a proactive Recession Readiness Playbook. One that enables scenario-based workforce planning, early risk detection, and predefined talent and cost levers to navigate economic downturns with speed and consistency.

Just like a gym begins with a health assessment and a personalized fitness plan,

Submitted by: Saghana Suresh Kumar **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Just like a gym begins with a health assessment and a personalized fitness plan, this experience introduces an AI Career Health Check paired with a customized, AI-ready career roadmap for HR professionals. It brings clarity to how HR roles are evolving with AI and provides practical next steps to stay ahead. Built with a deep understanding of HR mindsets, it feels supportive and empowering—guiding growth in a way that's developmental, not evaluative.

The FLSA Classification Advisor is inspired by SHRM's FLSA Exemptions Flow Chart

Submitted by: Jessica Langlois **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

The FLSA Classification Advisor is inspired by SHRM's FLSA Exemptions Flow Chart (https://www.shrm.org/topics-tools/tools/forms/flsa-exemption-flow-chart), transforming it into a 360 degree decision engine. Like the document builder, it addresses a frequent member request ("is this position exempt or nonexempt?") that Knowledge Advisors are unable to directly deliver. Members can upload an existing job description for analysis and FLSA determination or they can walk through a guided questionnaire. It provides users the option to determine whether a role is properly classified as an independent contractor. The tool has an embedded educational component ("Learn") that expands on the definitions of FLSA classifications and common misclassification scenarios. Users can create an account which allows them to save their history, build an audit trail, and export reports.

SHRM's signature conferences are one of our most valuable assets, but the path f

Submitted by: Audrey Rodriguez **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

SHRM's signature conferences are one of our most valuable assets, but the path from interest to participation isn't as clear or compelling as it could be, especially for B2B buyers and time-constrained HR professionals.

Today, both individuals and organizational decision-makers struggle to quickly understand the ROI: how attending translates into custom career growth, team performance, and business impact.

To address this, I propose a dynamic, gated "HR Growth & ROI Quiz, " an 11-question interactive experience designed for both individual contributors and B2B decision-makers.

Based on responses, participants receive a personalized output that includes:

-A tailored journey map aligned to their career or organizational goals
-A clear ROI projection (skills gained, team impact, retention, etc.)
-Recommended conference pathways and learning tracks

For individuals, this becomes a ready-made business case to share with their manager. For decision-makers, it provides a scalable way to evaluate the value of sending teams to SHRM conferences.

This approach creates a faster, more personalized path to value, ultimately driving higher conversion, stronger B2B engagement, and increased conference participation at scale.

I created a daily 10-15 minute AI-generated audio digest podcast summarizing the

Submitted by: Veronica Magan **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

I created a daily 10-15 minute AI-generated audio digest podcast summarizing the top HR news from SHRM's HR Daily newsletter. This would be similar to NPR's Up First Podcast.

I built a Global HR Compliance Tracker that maps out international policies and

Submitted by: Tiani Mccarthy **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

I built a Global HR Compliance Tracker that maps out international policies and laws enacted within the past 12 months, organized by key HR focus areas. It addresses a major challenge our international members face today keeping up with rapidly changing regulations. This tool is designed for International HR leaders and teams, especially those managing employees across multiple countries, who need a clear, centralized view of what's changed and where to focus their attention.

Bloom is a guided first 90 days (or a specified timeline depending on needs) for

Submitted by: Abby Harrington **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Bloom is a guided first 90 days (or a specified timeline depending on needs) for every new hire, with built-in visibility for managers and HR.

Employees get: a personal timeline of tasks and milestones, day by day; a searchable document library with everything they need; scheduled check-ins to share how they're doing; Ask Bloom, an AI assistant that answers policy questions from company docs; and real-time notifications when something needs their attention.

Managers get: a team dashboard with progress and engagement at a glance; per-employee detail views with timeline and check-in history; ability to add team-specific tasks and check-ins on top of HR's baseline; individual task assignment for one-off requests; and live alerts when teammates submit check-ins; and more.

HR gets:company-wide dashboard with completion rates, engagement trends, and at-risk hires; tools to build the onboarding timeline, check-in templates, documents, and FAQs; full employee and team management, filterable by team; and deep engagement analytics across every cohort.

The SHRM Work Radar is a personalized, proactive intelligence and alerting syste

Submitted by: Brett Roth **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

The SHRM Work Radar is a personalized, proactive intelligence and alerting system that combines real-time monitoring with forward-looking insights to help HR professionals stay ahead of change—not react to it.
This Product has three modalities: Work Alerts for the policies affecting one's organization now, Horizon Index for policies and SHRM predictions that could affect one's organization in the future, and Advocate which allows everyone to find a cause they care about and get involved in seeing it become reality. By merging Work Alerts (what changed) with Horizon Index (what's coming), Work Radar delivers clear, role-relevant guidance tailored to each member's responsibilities, location, and industry.

Tool: Pulse Survey Insight Generator

Submitted by: Olivia Pagan **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Tool: Pulse Survey Insight Generator

Purpose: The purpose of this tool is to turn employee feedback into clear, actionable insight within seconds. HR teams regularly collect valuable employee feedback but sharing that data and turning that data into meaningful action often takes significant manual work and time. This tool was designed as a first step to changing that. The Pulse Survey Insight Generator uses AI to instantly analyze employee pulse survey results—whether pasted text or uploaded files—and transforms them into structured, decision-ready top-line insights. Designed for speed and simplicity, this tool helps HR professionals move from data collection to delivering top-line findings with a quick turnaround.

What it delivers:

- Executive summary of overall sentiment.
- Key themes shaping the employee experience.
- Risk signals (e.g., burnout, disengagement, attrition etc.).
- Actionable recommendations for HR and managers.
- Positive highlights to build on.
- The ability to: Copy insights generated by the tool into other documents.
- The ability to: Export generated insights into a Word document or PowerPoint slide deck, making it easier for HR to quickly share top-level pulse insights with teams and leadership.

What it does not currently do: Provide deeper and detailed insight into specific survey questions, provide data breakdowns by respondent populations (i.e., feedback from marketing team vs sales team vs IT team etc.), assist with trend comparisons over time, or conduct statistical analysis. Instead, it is designed to take a more high-level view of the data and provide HR teams with a quick starting point and with the ability to share out some immediate findings while they conduct more detailed analysis.

Ideas for continued areas of refinement/development:

- Allow for top-level comparison across different data files and top-line trend comparison over time.
- Additional SHRM branding/styling to the tool.
- Refining Word/PowerPoint exports to generate more executive ready materials.
- Adding an option for users to upload their own organization's logos/branding for their Word/PowerPoint export generations.

Current limitation to note: In its current version, clearly labeled columns in data shared with the tool are essential to insight accuracy. All open-ended data is clearly understood by the tool but for quantitative results question clarity is needed. For example, a question with the column label “Q1” will not be fully understood or accurately analyzed while a question labeled “Org_Satisfaction” will be.

How the Tool was created: The tool was built in Loveable using text prompts. ChatGPT was utilized to help generate these text prompts and to generate a sample survey data file with 1,000 AI generated responses for testing/demonstration purposes.

The Recruiters Workbench is the start of building an ecosystem of role-based wor

Submitted by: Brett Roth **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

The Recruiters Workbench is the start of building an ecosystem of role-based workbenches for our members. These workbenches will help them utilize SHRM resources, research, and tools seamlessly within their day-to-day responsibilities. For recruiters, this workbench allows them to store company job posting templates, start job posting projects based on our directory of job descriptions personalized through AI, then easily send that posting to job boards (including SHRM HR Jobs), and then easily create interview scripts for hiring managers and teams utilizing our interview questions directory. This app should increase SHRM daily visits, positioning us as a necessary utility, not just a resource library.

Why HR Professionals Need a Better Multistate Law Comparison Tool:

Submitted by: Andi Riggs **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Why HR Professionals Need a Better Multistate Law Comparison Tool:

For HR professionals operating across multiple states, compliance is not just complex, it's constantly evolving. Each state, and often local jurisdictions, enforces its own requirements governing wages, leave, discrimination, benefits, and workplace safety.

The result is a fragmented legal landscape that creates significant administrative burden and increases the risk of noncompliance. HR teams must balance the need for consistency in policies with the reality of jurisdiction-specific obligations—often under tight time constraints.

While existing resources, such as SHRM's Multistate Law Comparison Tool, offer valuable information, they often present challenges that limit usability and effectiveness:
-Fragmented Content: Legal requirements are buried in dense text or inconsistent formats, making cross-state comparisons difficult.
-Limited Visibility: The absence of visual structure makes it hard to quickly identify key differences and similarities.
-Lack of Actionability: Most tools, including SHRM's, stop at explaining the law, without helping HR professionals translate requirements into practical policies or next steps.

Our Pay Transparency Comparison Tool is an enhanced, chart-based comparison tool that transforms how HR professionals engage with multistate compliance:
-Side-by-Side Visual Comparisons: Intuitive charts allow users to instantly compare legal requirements across jurisdictions, reducing cognitive load and saving time.
-Actionable Guidance: Built-in recommendations, best practices, and compliance checklists help translate legal requirements into clear, implementable policies.
-Expert-Driven Insights: Up-to-date legal analysis ensures accuracy and reliability, minimizing the risk of misinterpretation or oversight.
-Proactive Risk Identification: Highlighted differences and potential pitfalls enable HR teams to anticipate and mitigate compliance risks before they escalate.

This enhanced solution streamlines multistate compliance, reduces errors, and empowers HR teams to act with greater speed and confidence.

SHRM Policy Change Radar is a lightweight AI + HI prototype that helps HR leader

Submitted by: Christian Von Borstel | **Team:**

Problem & Solution

SHRM Policy Change Radar is a lightweight AI + HI prototype that helps HR leaders quickly understand emerging workforce policy changes and turn them into practical action. The challenge it addresses is that HR teams are often overwhelmed by fast-moving legislation and regulatory updates across states and at the federal level, making it difficult to know what matters, what to prioritize, and what steps to take next. This tool is designed for HR professionals, compliance teams, and executives who need a simple way to monitor policy trends, assess readiness, and respond with confidence through human-reviewed action plans.

HR Investigation Simulator

Submitted by: Alice Clark **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

HR Investigation Simulator

What it does: An interactive, scenario-based training app that puts learners in the seat of an HR investigator. Users work through realistic workplace cases (harassment, retaliation, expense fraud, union grievance) using a structured 7-step investigation framework — making decisions, conducting witness interviews, reviewing evidence artifacts (emails, policies, transcripts), and receiving framework-aligned feedback at the end. Each case opens with a cinematic, Netflix-style intro to set the stakes, then drops the user into a tabbed dashboard for decisions, interviews, and the case file.

The problem: HR investigations are high-stakes, legally sensitive, and notoriously hard to teach. Traditional training is passive — slide decks, policy PDFs, and compliance videos that don't build judgment. New HR professionals, people managers, and ER specialists rarely get to practice before their first real case, where mistakes can mean lawsuits, lost trust, and harm to employees. There's no safe sandbox for learning how to weigh credibility, sequence interviews, or recognize retaliation patterns.

Who it's for:
Early-career HR & ER professionals building investigative judgment before their first live case
People managers who need to recognize when to escalate and how investigations actually work
L&D and compliance teams at mid-to-large organizations looking for engaging, defensible training that goes beyond checkbox compliance
HR certification candidates and graduate programs needing applied case practice

SHRM PathFinder

Submitted by: Alice Clark **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

SHRM PathFinder

What it does: SHRM Pathfinder is an interactive recommendation engine that turns SHRM's full education portfolio — certifications, specialty credentials, seminars, and eLearning — into a personalized learning path in under 60 seconds. Users answer a short, branching quiz about their career stage, goals, focus area, and learning preferences, and receive a curated three-tier path: a Hero recommendation (the best-fit credential or certification), a Build Your Path sequence of supporting seminars and credentials, and Quick Wins they can knock out today. Every recommendation comes with a plain-English "why this fits you" explanation, drawn directly from the official SHRM Education Catalog.

The problem it solves: SHRM offers one of the richest HR education portfolios in the industry — but that breadth is also the challenge. Today, customers landing on shrm.org face limited guidance on which program actually fits their goals. The result is decision friction: prospects bounce and high-intent learners default to whatever they've heard of instead of what's right for them. Pathfinder reframes program discovery from "browse a catalog" into "get advice from an expert" — collapsing a confusing exploration into a confident, guided next step.

Who it's for:
HR professionals at every career stage — from early-career practitioners learning the fundamentals to senior leaders pursuing strategic credentials like AI+HI or People Analytics.
SHRM Marketing & Member Experience teams — as both a UX improvement that reduces drop-off and a lead-generation tool that surfaces high-intent learners and routes them to the right program.
HR leaders making team-development decisions — who need a fast way to map roles to relevant SHRM offerings.

State and Local Minimum Wage Law Assistant

Submitted by: Rebecca Cooper **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

State and Local Minimum Wage Law Assistant

Team members: Rebecca Cooper, lead for Tools and Guides Content, led a team effort to arrive at this solution. The team also included Allen Smith and Rachel Zheliabovskii from Thought Leadership Content, and Katie Brennan from the Knowledge Center.

Problem: HR professionals face a maze of different state employment laws that are always changing. One big pain point for HR is getting the most up-to-date information on those laws in a succinct, digestible way. Members have commented that even SHRM's own offering, the Multistate Law Comparison Tool from Wolters Kluwer, provides too much jargony information without cutting to the chase about requirements that apply to them.

Solution: Our AI-powered, Multistate Minimum Wage Law Assistant builds on existing vetted legal information from SHRM partner Wolters Kluwer to provide more user-friendly and readily accessible information on state and local minimum wage laws. This idea could be replicated for other state and local employment laws.

How it Works: The tool allows the user to search either by individual states or to compare the requirements across states. The multistate function includes an interactive map where users of the tool may click on the states they're interested in to find out state and local minimum wage requirements, which can be more complex than they seem at first glance. The tool points out exceptions to each state's minimum wage requirements.

Next Generation: This tool is pulling from a static download of Minimum Wage information from Wolters Kluwer, as well as a Berkeley.edu source for California locality minimum wage data. A deployed version of this tool should access the latest Wolters Kluwer legal resources via Vital Law or employment law smart charts, which SHRM already pays to license for members, in real time. It could also add in a broader AI search for more up-to-date information, prioritizing .gov and .us websites as sources.

We could see a scenario where a future SHRM AI tool or Knowledge Advisors refer members to a State Employment Law Assistant for these types of question (or perhaps more usefully, more specific assistants tailored to particularly high-traffic topics, such as a State Family Medical Leave Law Assistant or State New Hire Paperwork Assistant).

InsideTrack

Submitted by: Alice Clark **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

InsideTrack

What it does: InsideTrack is an internal talent-matching tool. Paste a job description (or pick an open role), and it instantly ranks your existing employees by how well their skills fit — with a match %, strong/partial tags, and a candidate detail view showing matched vs. missing skills. Admins can grow the talent pool by uploading resumes (parsed by AI into structured skill profiles) and add new open roles with auto-extracted requirements.

The problem: Companies spend months and tens of thousands of dollars sourcing external candidates while qualified people already sit inside the org — invisible because their skills live in scattered resumes, HRIS fields, and manager memory. Internal mobility is slow, biased toward who you know, and almost never the first move when a role opens.

Who it's for:
Talent acquisition & people teams who want a "look inside first" step before posting externally.
Hiring managers who need a fast, defensible shortlist of internal candidates.
HR / People Ops leaders measuring internal mobility, retention, and skills visibility.
Employees (downstream) who get surfaced for stretch roles they'd never have heard about.

Why it matters Internal hires ramp faster, cost less, and stay longer. InsideTrack turns "who do we know?" into a 10-second search.

CareOS — Employer Caregiver Intelligence Platform

Submitted by: Shayla Alexander-Milligan **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

CareOS — Employer Caregiver Intelligence Platform

The problem

Caregiving has become a structural workforce crisis. According to publicly available SHRM research, three in four workers are managing some caregiving responsibility — yet 32% never disclose their status to their employer, meaning most support programs never reach the people who need them. Caregivers miss an average of 1.2 workdays per month when unsupported, costing an estimated $17.5 billion in lost wages monthly across the U.S. workforce. When caregivers do disclose, outcomes depend entirely on which manager they have: 48% receive support, 22% face scrutiny. That inconsistency is both a culture problem and a legal liability. Despite all of this, less than 12% of employers conduct an annual caregiving assessment. Most are navigating this blind.

What CareOS does

CareOS is a five-module employer intelligence platform that gives HR leaders and managers the infrastructure to treat caregiving as a strategic workforce issue — not a one-off accommodation request.

Caregiver OS – centralizes all policies, active accommodations, resources, and disclosure tracking in one place — and surfaces compliance gaps before they become liabilities.

Manager Playbook Engine – is AI-powered decision support for the moment that matters most: when a manager doesn't know what to say or do after a caregiver disclosure. It returns structured response options, legal flags, a conversation guide, and documentation requirements — so outcomes don't depend on any one manager's intuition.

Experience Assessment – diagnoses the organization across six dimensions — policy maturity, culture safety, manager readiness, elder care coverage, and more — benchmarked against SHRM industry data. It makes the invisible visible.

Strategy Playbook – turns assessment findings into a customized implementation roadmap, tiered by company size and maturity and sequenced across a 90-day to 12-month horizon.

Metrics Dashboard – tracks caregiver retention, absenteeism, benefit utilization, and

accommodation ROI over time — giving CHROs the numbers to prove business case and measure progress.

Who it's for

CHROs and VP Benefits at employers of 500–20,000 who know caregiving is affecting their workforce but lack the data to measure it or build a business case for it.

Strategic HR Business Partners who need a consistent, legally-sound framework for handling caregiver requests, not a policy PDF to interpret under pressure.

People Managers, the frontline of caregiver experience, who currently lack structured support. SHRM's 2026 CHRO Priorities report names manager development the top organizational priority for the second consecutive year. CareOS addresses that priority directly.

Why now

Caregiving appears on SHRM's official Top Five Workplace Issues list for 2026. Fifty percent of CHROs expect rising RTO mandates that will collide with the caregiving responsibilities of the fastest-growing employee segment. All Baby Boomers will have reached 65 by 2027, meaning elder care volume is about to surge at the exact moment employer readiness is lowest. The existing software market serves home care agencies, not employers. That gap is what CareOS fills.

All statistics drawn from publicly available SHRM research: the Care and Careers report (2024), the 2025 Employee Benefits Survey, the 2026 State of the Workplace report, the 2026 CHRO Priorities and Perspectives report, and SHRM's Top Five Workplace Issues for 2026.

Create an interactive, AI-driven career planning tool that guides users through

Submitted by: Suleman Hafeez **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Create an interactive, AI-driven career planning tool that guides users through a personalized journey and increases conversion into SHRM products and services.
VALUE (KEY):
• Introduces a personalized HR career engine that converts engagement directly into SHRM revenue
• Positions certifications as required career milestones—not suggestions—making progression feel incomplete without them
• Transforms SHRM credentials into visible checkpoints in the journey, reinforcing necessity, urgency, and perceived ROI
• Uses a free diagnostic (career path, readiness score, skill gaps) to drive initial user buy-in
• Locks high-value, actionable insights behind SHRM membership to create clear upgrade intent
• Builds urgency with data-driven insights on timelines, role readiness, and market competitiveness
• Embeds SHRM learning and certification as the default, structured path to advancement
• Uses progress tracking and milestone completion to sustain engagement and retention
• Drives conversion across the funnel: anonymous users → members → certification candidates
• Increases lifetime value by making SHRM integral to achieving and accelerating career goals

built a workflow tracking app that helps users manage multiple repeatable tasks

Submitted by: Heather Hughes **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

built a workflow tracking app that helps users manage multiple repeatable tasks at the same time. Instead of using a basic to-do list, it tracks each item through the same step-by-step process—such as creating sponsor agreements, processing invoices, onboarding requests, or approvals.

The challenge it solves is losing your place when juggling several identical workflows at once, especially when interruptions happen. Users can check off completed steps, pause, and return later without missing anything.

It's also designed for managers, giving real-time visibility into how long tasks take, where bottlenecks happen, and where errors or delays repeat. It's ideal for teams handling high-volume operational work with recurring processes throughout the day.

HR Ready to Work Simulation Pilot

Submitted by: Liz Petersen **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

HR Ready to Work Simulation Pilot

What it Does:
The virtual simulation pilot is an AI-driven, interactive scenario designed to immerse users in realistic HR situations that require critical thinking, decision-making, and effective communication. Users must actively investigate, ask clarifying questions, and make choices that reveal underlying legal, ethical, and practical issues—mirroring the ambiguity and complexity of real-world HR work. To complete the simulation, the users complete a Summary Report for their HR Director of their findings and recommendations. Upon completion, they receive a scorecard and debrief highlighting strengths, areas for improvement, missed issues, and potential risks.

Problem/Challenge Addressed:
This simulation addresses the gap between theoretical HR education and real-world practice. Traditional internships and classroom learning often fail to expose students and early-career professionals to the nuanced, "grey area" situations that define effective HR management. Many students and career changers struggle to access meaningful internships, and employers seek candidates with practical, strategic thinking skills that go beyond textbook knowledge.

Target Audience:
- HR students (undergraduate and graduate)
- Early-career and emerging HR professionals
- Career changers entering HR
- Educators seeking high-quality, experiential learning tools
- SHRM members looking to upskill
- SHRM Business clients interested in advancing HR proficiency among their workforce

I built a Sponsors ROI Risk Alerts prototype to help sales teams improve renewal

Submitted by: Heather Hughes **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

I built a Sponsors ROI Risk Alerts prototype to help sales teams improve renewals and reduce post-event cancellations. One of the biggest challenges after events is that exhibitors and sponsors often rebook while excitement is high, but a few months later those commitments can be questioned internally by finance leaders if there is no clear proof of ROI.

The tool helps solve that problem by turning lead retrieval data into actionable insights. Users can upload spreadsheets with lead counts, attendee titles, notes, and engagement metrics. The app analyzes performance, compares results against event averages, identifies trends, and flags sponsors who may be at risk of canceling or not renewing.

It also provides suggestions for proactive follow-up conversations, helping account teams speak with sponsors before concerns grow. It's designed for sponsorship and exhibitor sales teams that need stronger retention tools, smarter forecasting, and data-backed renewal conversations.

At most organizations, recruiters are instructed to use the job description and

Submitted by: Calven Engstrom **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

At most organizations, recruiters are instructed to use the job description and qualities identified by the hiring manager to identify candidates to move forward in the process, often restricting the pool they can source from. However, we understand that the prior experience people have and what core abilities are needed for a position are more nuanced than what you can write out in a job ad. Additionally, many recruiters have trouble identifying the transferable skills of candidates, especially if they are applying for roles in a new field. The inability to assess and evaluate the transferable skills of applicants means recruiters and organizations are missing out on untapped talent potential by overlooking candidates that don't meet all the requirements of a job description.
While there are resources available that map out the core abilities and duties for various occupations, these data sources are complicated for the average person to look through. AdjacenSee incorporates data from O*NET's skills and abilities work activities and context modules, creating a skills to abilities matrix, allowing users to easily evaluate candidates through a skills-first approach. AdjacenSee identifies the untapped strengths candidates can bring to a position that even the recruiter or organization did not consider, becoming an invaluable learning tool HR professionals can use to understand the skills that may lie beneath the surface.

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Submitted by: Sydney Ross **| Team:**

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HirePrep is a two-sided mock interview platform that connects early-career candi

Submitted by: Kevin Abbed **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

HirePrep is a two-sided mock interview platform that connects early-career candidates, especially HR and business students with SHRM-verified practitioners for live, 30-minute practice interviews, complete with built-in scheduling, video links, in-session chat and notes, and structured 5-category feedback they can track over time. It solves a real gap: students rarely get realistic reps before high-stakes interviews, career centers can't scale 1:1 coaching, and thousands of HR pros who want to mentor have no lightweight way to do it. By gating access to verified SHRM members and standardizing feedback with a clear rubric, HirePrep turns scattered goodwill into measurable growth giving students the reps they need and giving practitioners (and the SHRM chapters and university career centers that support them) a turnkey way to pay it forward at scale. Future positive effects could also impact the TA Specialty Credential, while also potentially giving HR practitioners PDC credits. (portal built in).

EVOLVE: AI-Powered Workforce Intelligence Platform

Submitted by: Alaina Leadbeter **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

EVOLVE: AI-Powered Workforce Intelligence Platform
Positioned with SHRM Messaging

EVOLVE, powered by SHRM, is an AI-driven workforce intelligence platform that empowers enterprise leaders to make data-backed decisions for workforce transformation. By integrating enterprise data with SHRM's trusted research, EVOLVE optimizes talent deployment, identifies capability gaps, and models organizational structures. The platform delivers actionable insights and executive-ready briefs, enabling leaders to act with confidence and precision.

Key Features

Data-Driven Insights: Analyzes workforce data (roles, skills, tenure, performance, etc.) to uncover gaps.
Combines internal data with SHRM's external market intelligence for a holistic view.
Scenario Modeling: Provides three talent pathways for critical roles: internal redeployment, up-skilling, or external hiring.
Models structural alternatives to compare scenarios before implementation.
Executive Briefs: Generates concise, one-page summaries with recommendations, action plans, and risk assessments.
Six-Step Workflow: Guides users through defining objectives, confirming data, analyzing, reviewing findings, comparing scenarios, and exporting briefs.

Technical Details

Frontend: React 18, Vite, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS.
Backend: Edge functions (Deno), Postgres database, AI orchestration.
AI Integration:
Skill normalization, recommendation synthesis, and brief composition.
Privacy-focused with anonymized data processing to ensure compliance and security.

Target Audience

CHROs and Heads of People.
HR Business Partners.
Talent and Org Design Leads.

Workforce Planning Analysts.

Challenges Addressed

Limited visibility into internal talent.
Misaligned roles and organizational structures.
Decisions disconnected from market and workforce realities.

Differentiators

Combines SHRM's authoritative research with enterprise data for unparalleled insights.
Scalable and repeatable workforce intelligence tailored to evolving business needs.
Prioritizes decision-readiness, delivering clarity and actionable guidance over traditional dashboards.

SHRM Alignment

EVOLVE embodies SHRM's mission to provide HR leaders with real-time intelligence, actionable insights, and strategic clarity. By leveraging SHRM's research and expertise, EVOLVE positions HR as a strategic partner in shaping workforce decisions, ensuring compliance, and driving performance.

HR Stack Navigator is a diagnostic assessment tool that helps HR leaders quickly

Submitted by: Hadeel Al-Tashi **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

HR Stack Navigator is a diagnostic assessment tool that helps HR leaders quickly evaluate the health and completeness of their HR technology stack. By walking through a guided assessment, HR teams can identify gaps, redundancies, and opportunities in their current toolset, generating a clear picture of where their stack is strong and where it's falling short. It's designed to be the "front door" to smarter HR tech decisions, and a natural launchpad for a marketplace experience where teams can discover and fill the missing pieces in their stack.

Research consistently shows employees leave managers, not companies—yet the most

Submitted by: Sharon Lo **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

Research consistently shows employees leave managers, not companies—yet the most critical insights about performance, engagement, and risk are buried in one-on-one conversations that go uncaptured and unused. This platform transforms those moments into real-time organizational intelligence by enabling managers to capture key themes, while AI identifies patterns in employee sentiment, performance, flight risk, and potential HR risks, including legal and compliance issues. It goes further by coaching managers—using company-specific policies like the employee handbook—to guide better, more consistent, and compliant decision-making.

At the leadership level, it surfaces manager effectiveness, employee morale, and emerging risks, escalating issues to HR when appropriate. The result is stronger managers, reduced attrition, and a more proactive, data-driven approach to protecting and improving the employee experience.

SHRM Metric Matchup — instant HR benchmarking

Submitted by: Nathan Ebikwo **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

SHRM Metric Matchup — instant HR benchmarking

What it does: Input or upload key HR metrics and instantly benchmark against SHRM data. Get percentile rankings, anomaly flags, an AI executive summary, and a "cost of inaction" in dollars.

The problem: HR has data but can't answer "are we good?" in business terms. Benchmarks are buried in PDFs, and leaders struggle to translate metrics into financial impact.

Who it's for: CHROs, HRBPs, and People leaders who need fast, board-ready insights without consulting overhead.

The wedge: Multiple input modes, role-based views, and one-click outputs that turn raw metrics into prioritized, dollar-backed decisions.

SHRM Guardian — AI HR compliance copilot

What it does: Upload policies or job posts and instantly flag compliance risks across U.S. and global laws. It scores risk, prioritizes issues (P0–P3), drafts fixes with citations, and tracks remediation. Includes a copilot for plain-English questions, plus a live regulatory calendar and targeted HR news.

The problem: HR teams face fast-changing, complex regulations but rely on slow, expensive, point-in-time audits. Gaps are missed, risks grow, and existing tools are built for lawyers—not operators.

Who it's for: HR leaders, compliance teams, and legal partners who need a fast, reliable, always-on view of policy risk.

Why now: AI regulation is exploding—and the same tech can now monitor, interpret, and fix compliance in real time.

Product Pulse — AI-powered portfolio health for product leaders

What it does: Upload any mix of CSVs, Excel, PDFs, or docs. The system auto-maps data to KPIs, scores each product across six dimensions, assigns a health tier, and delivers clear actions (OPTIMIZE, FIX, SCALE, SUNSET) with rationale. It also flags anomalies and surfaces cross-product opportunities.

The problem: Product portfolios live in fragmented spreadsheets. Reviews are slow, inconsistent, and driven by gut—not data. Traditional BI tools require heavy setup and data teams.

Who it's for: Product leaders, GMs, and portfolio operators who need a fast, defensible, board-ready view across many products.

The wedge: Zero setup. Messy data in, prioritized decisions out.

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A research-backed web calculator that turns six inputs about an organization's w

Submitted by: Anika Dhir **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

A research-backed web calculator that turns six inputs about an organization's workforce — headcount, salary, turnover, engagement, and manager training - into a hard-dollar estimate of what ineffective management is costing an organization. It breaks the cost into four drivers (turnover, lost productivity, absenteeism, HR time), projects it across five years, and shows how SHRM's leadership solutions (PMQ+) could close the gap. It's designed for HR and business leaders who need to make the business case for investing in their managers — CHROs, VPs of People, L&D directors, and the CEOs and CFOs they need to convince.

People Analytics in Action is a self-paced simulation that puts HR professionals

Submitted by: Alice Clark **| Team:**

Problem & Solution

People Analytics in Action is a self-paced simulation that puts HR professionals inside a realistic case as the People Analytics partner to a business unit. Across six phases — Brief, Data Room, Analysis, Recommendation, Executive Defense, and Debrief — learners interrogate datasets, separate strong signal from misleading patterns, build a root-cause narrative, defend it to skeptical executives, and get coached on what they missed.

The problem: Most HR analytics training teaches statistics, not judgment. In the real job, the hard part isn't running the numbers — it's choosing which question to ask, recognizing when a chart is misleading, and influencing a CFO or CPO who already has a theory. There's no safe place to practice that loop.

The solution: Four fully built scenarios (Engineering Attrition, Engagement Decline, Hiring Bottleneck, Representation Gap) with branching data requests, stakeholder personas with competing priorities, and an optional Coaching Mode that can be turned off for true difficulty. Every decision is graded against an expert take, so learners see exactly where their reasoning diverged from a senior practitioner's.

Who it's for: HRBPs, People Analytics analysts, and HR leaders who need to translate data into business influence — from early-career practitioners building the muscle to senior leaders pressure-testing their instincts before a real boardroom moment.